

Name: _____

Chapter 1 - Theories

For each trait, describe how it explains our cognitions (thoughts) and behaviors, as well as any important people associated with the perspective

Perspective	Focus / How it explains thoughts and behaviors	Important People
Biological/ Neuroscience	Behavior and thoughts come from the body, especially the brain, genes, and hormones. Tied to neuroscience, the study of the brain and nervous system.	Modern neuroscientists (no single founder)
Developmental	How thinking and behavior change as we grow across the lifespan, from infancy to old age.	Piaget, Erikson, Vygotsky, G. Stanley Hall
Cognitive	Behavior is driven by mental processes like thinking, memory, and language. Brought the mind back into psychology after behaviorism.	George Miller (7 plus or minus 2 memory research)
Psychodynamic	Modern version of Freud's ideas. Unconscious processes and early childhood experiences shape thoughts and behavior.	Freud, plus Jung, Adler, Horney, Erikson

Perspective	Focus / How it explains our thoughts and behaviors	Important People
Humanistic	People are basically good and naturally grow in a positive direction. Choice and free will matter.	Carl Rogers, Abraham Maslow
Behavioral	Behavior is learned from the environment through associations, rewards and punishments, and watching others.	Pavlov, Watson, Skinner
Social-cultural	Other people and our culture shape how we think and behave.	Lev Vygotsky
Evolutionary	Natural selection shaped our thoughts and behaviors because they helped our ancestors survive and reproduce.	Charles Darwin, David Buss
Psychoanalytic	Unconscious conflicts between our desires and society's expectations drive behavior. Childhood matters a lot.	Sigmund Freud
Biopsychosocial	Behavior comes from biological, psychological, and social factors all interacting together.	Combined approach, no single founder